

Post-incident review PIR-2025-064

Order Management: failed sign-ins

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 31 December 2025, Order Management experienced failed sign-ins in production (AU East) for about 110 minutes. A partner raised a case with the service desk before any internal signal fired. Investigation found that the TLS cipher list was tightened as part of a hardening rollout, and older clients could no longer negotiate a connection.

Impact

Users of Order Management saw failed sign-ins for about 110 minutes. The service owner, Commerce Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:17 First signal received.
- 09:22 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:48 Likely cause identified.
- 10:18 Mitigation applied.
- 10:38 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the TLS cipher list was tightened as part of a hardening rollout, and older clients could no longer negotiate a connection.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.